

JULIA JANA

THE PULLED

*You are standing in the Forum. The senators are arguing — about grain, about the frontier, about something you cannot quite hear. You watch them and notice, with a clarity that should trouble you, which ones could be removed without disrupting the vote count. You notice this before you notice their faces. You notice it before you notice whether you know them.*

*Your father is there. You notice that he is an obstacle before you notice that he is your father. The recognition comes a moment later, and then the shame — but the shame comes second. It came second. That is the thing you carry when you wake.*

*Janus governs thresholds. You have always known what lies on either side of a door. What is new is which side is starting to feel like home.*

WHAT OTHERS NOTICE

*Your patience has shortened. Not dramatically — you are still functional, still composed. But people who know you well can see it: the margin between frustration and action is narrower than it used to be. You speak about difficult solutions casually, in conversations where you would not have before.*

MECHANICAL EFFECT

You have disadvantage on Wisdom saving throws. This persists until your corruption level changes. Your GM knows this. You may not have disclosed it to your companions.

JOURNAL PROMPT

*When did I stop thinking of an enemy as a person — and can I remember the last time I thought of them as one?*